Facilitator guide — Slide Decks

Facilitator guide · Slide Decks · 4 activities · ~60 min + demo

Purpose

Slide Decks teaches participants to assemble what they have already built — charts and interpretations — into a presentation. It follows a build-then-polish arc: create the deck container, watch the editor demonstrated, add charts two ways (manually and with the AI), then finalize. The output is the artefact participants will actually show decision-makers, so the standard to hold is presentation-ready, not merely complete.

By the end, each participant should have a saved, polished two-slide deck, built from charts they created earlier, that they would be willing to show to a Director.

Session at a glance

#	Activity	Time	Format
—	Editor walkthrough demo	~5 min	Facilitator-led (appendix)
1	Create your first slide deck	~10 min	Hands-on, individual
2	Add a visualization (manually)	~15 min	Hands-on, individual
3	Add a visualization (with the AI)	~15 min	Hands-on, individual
4	Edit and finalize your slides	~20 min	Hands-on, individual

Running the session

Preparation. Have a deck with one empty content slide and at least one saved visualization ready in the demo account, so the editor demo runs without a hitch. Set browser zoom to ~100% so the interface is legible on the shared screen.

How to demonstrate. The sequence is **container → demo → do (manual) → do (AI) → polish.** Activity 1 sets up the deck; you then run the editor walkthrough (appendix) live *before* participants touch the editor. That demo is the gating moment for activities 2 and 3 — without it, participants will not know how to add a chart or split a slide. Run the appendix script as written; the activity handouts re-explain what you showed, they are not self-teaching.

Grouping. All four activities are individual hands-on work. Pair participants only for help when someone is stuck.

Pacing. Protect the demo and activity 4. If time runs short, let activity 3 (the AI route to the same result as activity 2) be the one that slips.

The message to carry through. Reuse, don't recreate: charts are built in the Visualizations tab and placed into slides here. The slide editor is for assembly and polish, not for building charts from scratch.

The activities

1. Create your first slide deck · ~10 min · hands-on

What happens. A short activity creating the deck container and a first content slide, which also teaches the three slide types: open the personal folder → Create slide deck and name it → Add slide → choose **Cover** (title page), **Section** (divider), or **Content** (chart + text). Participants pick Content.

Demonstrate. Show where the deck is created — *inside* the personal folder — and the slide-type chooser, calling out that only **Content** holds a chart and text.

Say something like. *"Create the deck inside your own folder, and pick Content — a Cover or Section slide has nowhere to put your chart."*

What a good result looks like. A named deck in the participant's personal folder with one editable content slide.

Watch for.

- The deck created *outside* the personal folder.
- Cover or Section chosen instead of Content — leaving nothing editable for the activities that follow.

> **Run the editor walkthrough demo now**, before activity 2. Use the appendix script.

2. Add a visualization (manually) · ~15 min · hands-on

What happens. A hands-on activity adding a saved chart to a slide via the editor menus, repeating what you demonstrated: open the deck → click into the content slide → Block → Visualization → Select → pick a chart the participant created → save.

Demonstrate. Covered in the appendix walkthrough (Step 2). No new demo needed; point participants back to what they saw.

Say something like. *"You're not building a chart here — you're picking one you already saved. If it's not in the list, it wasn't saved to Visualizations."*

What a good result looks like. A content slide showing one of the participant's own saved charts.

Watch for.

- Participants trying to rebuild charts inside the slide editor — reinforce "reuse, don't recreate".
- A chart missing from the picker — it simply was not saved to a Visualizations folder.

3. Add a visualization (with the AI) · ~15 min · hands-on

What happens. The same task by a different route: participants prompt the AI to surface a saved visualization, then use the chat preview's **Add to slide deck** button, ending with a two-slide deck.

Demonstrate. Show one AI request that surfaces a saved chart and the **Add to slide deck** button in the preview, so participants recognize it when it appears.

Say something like. *"The AI can only find charts you've already saved. If it shows the wrong one, save the chart you want and give it a clearer name."*

What a good result looks like. A two-slide deck, the second slide added through the AI route.

Watch for.

- The AI returning the wrong chart or no "Add to deck" button — the chart must be saved first and named specifically.

4. Edit and finalize your slides · ~20 min · hands-on

What happens. A polishing pass: four reviews per slide — accuracy check, resize text boxes, resize/reposition charts, adjust layout and spacing. Slides can be sent back to the AI for rewrites.

Demonstrate. Show where the resize divider appears (only after clicking into a slide) and one small text edit versus a structural rewrite that goes back to the AI.

Say something like. *"Small fixes you make here; structural rewrites go back to the AI. The bar is: could you show this slide to a Director without an apology?"*

What a good result looks like. Every slide reviewed for accuracy, with charts and text sized to fit and a clean layout.

Watch for.

- The resize divider not found — it only appears after clicking into a slide.
- A chart still cramped after resizing — it must be simplified back in the **Visualizations** tab, not the slide editor.

Closing the session

By the end, every participant has a saved, polished two-slide deck built from their own charts. Hold them to one bar: each slide could be shown to a Director without an apology.

Appendix — Editor walkthrough demo script

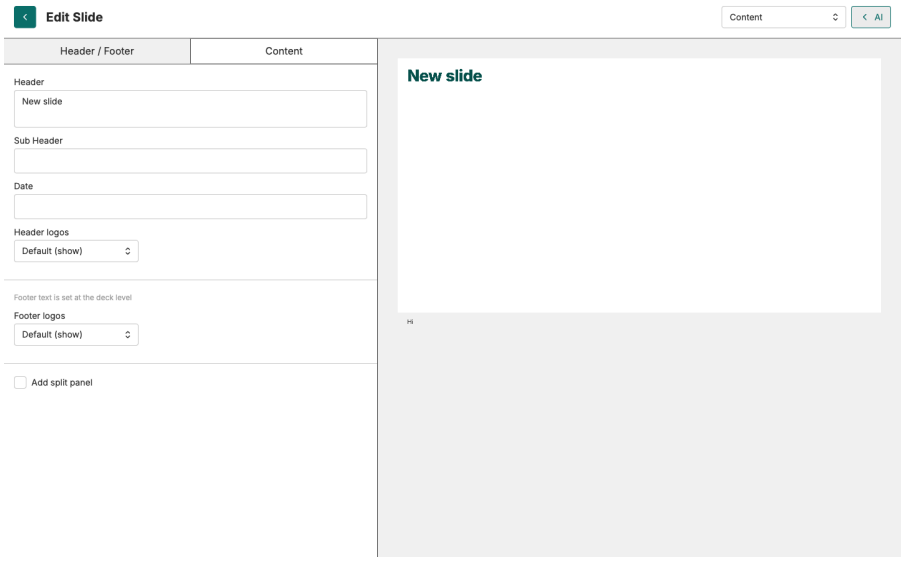
A 5-minute live tour of the slide editor. Participants have just created an empty content slide; this demo shows them how to put a chart and text on it, before they repeat it themselves in activity 2. Don't extend it — keep momentum.

Setup checklist

- ☐ A slide deck open with one **empty content slide** ready
- ☐ At least one saved visualization in the demo account
- ☐ Browser zoom set to ~100% so participants can see UI clearly
- ☐ Screen-share working if remote

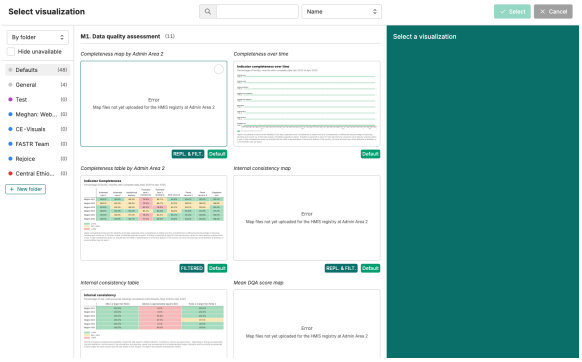
Step 1 — Open the editor

- **Do:** Click the empty content slide in the slide list.
- **Say:** *"Clicking the slide opens the editor. The preview is on the right; the editing options are on the left."*
- **Watch for:** Participants ask "where's the editor?" — answer: it's not a separate window, it's the right-hand pane that just appeared.



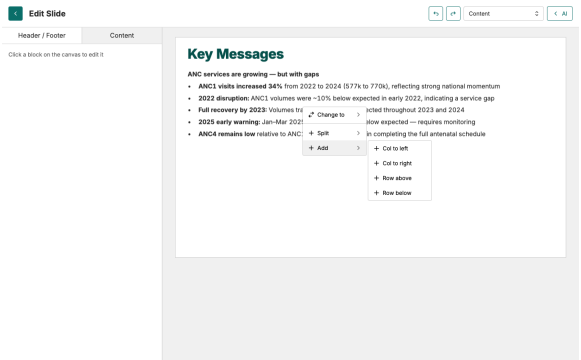
Step 2 — Add a visualization block

- **Do: Block → Visualization → Select visualization →** pick a saved chart **→ Select**. The chart fills the slide.
- **Say:** *"This is how you put a saved chart on a slide. You're not building a new chart here — you're picking one you already saved in the Visualizations tab."*
- **Watch for:** Reinforce **"reuse, don't recreate"** — the chart must already be saved in Visualizations. If a participant's chart isn't appearing in the picker, they need to go back and save it there first.



Step 3 — Split the slide into chart + text

- **Do:** Right-click in the slide preview **→ Add → Col to right →** click into the new text column and type a one-line takeaway.
- **Say:** *"Two columns is the FASTR pattern: chart on one side, the one thing you want the reader to take away on the other. If you need more, split into another slide."*
- **Watch for:** Participants try to fit four columns. Steer them back to two — extra content goes on the next slide.



Step 4 — Resize the chart and text areas

- **Do:** Hover the vertical divider between the chart and text columns. Cursor changes to a resize handle. Drag left or right.
- **Say:** *"Drag this to give the chart more room or the text more room. Both resize automatically."*
- **Watch for:** Participants who didn't notice the cursor change — point it out explicitly.

Step 5 — Edit slide details and save

- **Do:** Switch to the **Slide** tab → edit the slide title and subtitle. Switch to **Header/Footer** → date and footer. Save.
- **Say:** *"The Slide tab is the headline of the slide. Content is the text columns. Header/Footer is the small text at the bottom. Save when done — there's autosave but Save is your safety net."*
- **Watch for:** Participants ask whether they should edit text directly or go back to the AI — answer: small fixes here, structural rewrites go back to the AI.

Common questions

Q: Can I undo a resize?
A: Yes — Ctrl/Cmd-Z, or drag the divider back. Edits are not destructive.

Q: Does the editor save automatically?
A: Yes. The Save button is a manual safety net for major changes.

Q: Can I change the slide order in the editor?
A: No — slide ordering lives in the deck view. Drag slides in the slide list.

Backup plan

If the platform is down: walk through the screenshots in this appendix and describe the three-step pattern (Block → Visualization, then Col to right, then resize). Activity 2 (Add manually) reinforces the same flow.